

Daily Content Intel

July 22, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, camp starts in a couple of weeks, so let's talk about the hamstring you pull in October.

Researchers put GPS units on 67 elite soccer players and tracked them across 3 seasons. They logged the whole preseason: total distance, high-speed distance, sprint distance, sprint count, accelerations, decelerations. Then they waited and counted who strained a hamstring once the season started.

The variable that showed up was sprint distance. More preseason sprint distance meant lower in-season hamstring injury odds, roughly 10% lower per unit, and sprint count was

even stronger than that.

And that tracks with how the injury actually happens, right? A hamstring strains at the end of the swing phase, when it's lengthening fast under high velocity. Only real sprinting puts the tissue in that position at that speed. Reps at true top speed are the rehearsal.

So going into camp, get max velocity work on the calendar. 2 or 3 days a week, 20 to 40 yards, walk all the way back, full recovery between reps. If you're breathing hard, you're conditioning, and that's a different session on a different day.

This was pro soccer players, so I'd hold it a little loosely for a high school lineman. The mechanism carries over to football and lacrosse though, and the fix is free.

Sprinting is what makes you durable at sprinting.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The hamstring you pull in October gets decided in August.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, camp starts in a couple of weeks, so let's talk about the hamstring you pull in October.

Researchers put GPS units on 67 elite soccer players and tracked them across 3 seasons. They logged the whole preseason: total distance, high-speed distance, sprint distance, sprint count, accelerations, decelerations. Then they waited and counted who strained a hamstring once the season started.

The variable that showed up was sprint distance. More preseason sprint distance meant lower in-season hamstring injury odds, roughly 10% lower per unit, and sprint count was even stronger than that.

And that tracks with how the injury actually happens, right? A hamstring strains at the end of the swing phase, when it's lengthening fast under high velocity. Only real sprinting puts the tissue in that position at that speed. Reps at true top speed are the rehearsal.

So going into camp, get max velocity work on the calendar. 2 or 3 days a week, 20 to 40 yards, walk all the way back, full recovery between reps. If you're breathing hard, you're conditioning, and that's a different session on a different day.

This was pro soccer players, so I'd hold it a little loosely for a high school lineman. The mechanism carries over to football and lacrosse though, and the fix is free.

Sprinting is what makes you durable at sprinting.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 The hamstring you pull in October gets decided in August

- 0:08 67 pro players. 3 seasons. GPS on everything.
- 0:20 The variable that mattered: sprint distance
- 0:26 ~10% lower hamstring odds per unit
- 0:36 Strains happen at end of swing phase, at speed
- 0:48 2-3x/week. 20-40 yards. Walk back. Full recovery.
- 0:58 Breathing hard? That's conditioning, different day.
- 1:10 Sprinting makes you durable at sprinting

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Camp opens in a couple of weeks, so here's the preseason decision that shows up in October.

Researchers tracked 67 elite soccer players with GPS across 3 seasons and logged everything they did in preseason. The number that predicted in-season hamstring strains was sprint distance. More preseason sprint distance meant meaningfully lower injury odds, and sprint count held up even

stronger.

It makes sense mechanically. A hamstring strains at the end of the swing phase, lengthening fast at high velocity. Real sprinting is the only thing that rehearses that position at that speed.

What to actually do: put max velocity work on the calendar 2 or 3 days a week. 20 to 40 yards, walk all the way back, full recovery between reps. If you're gassed, you're conditioning, and that belongs on a different day.

This was pro soccer, so hold it loosely for a high school lineman. The mechanism carries to football and lacrosse, and it costs nothing to program.

It's time to cross your threshold. Dr. Lars
Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #lacrosse #speedtraining
#hamstring #athletedevelopment
#strengthandconditioning #youthathletes
#injuryprevention #sportsperformance
#restonva

Personalize this

- Your HS football camp opens in a few weeks. Which position groups in your program are getting real max velocity exposure right now, and which ones are only getting conditioned? Name the group you'd fix first.
- You've had athletes come back from a hamstring strain mid-season. Can you tell one story where the preseason sprint exposure was obviously missing, and what you changed in their return-to-sport progression because of it?
- How does max velocity work sit inside the CROSS framework for you, and how do you explain to a parent or a head coach that gassers are not the same stimulus as 3 true sprints with a full walk-back?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41327818/>
| "The Protective Effect of Preseason Running Workload Against In-Season Hamstring Strain Injuries in Elite Soccer Players"

- physiology | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41327818/> | "Increased preseason sprint distance was associated significantly with a reduced risk of in-season HSI (odds ratio [OR], 0.896; 95% CI, 0.822-0.976; P = 0.01)"
- actionable | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41327818/> | "Preseason training marked by higher sprint distances and counts demonstrates a protective effect against in-season HSI in elite soccer players"

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41327818/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take for August. Neck training probably doesn't prevent concussions, and I program it anyway.

Here's where the belief came from. A study years back reported that for every pound of neck strength, concussion odds dropped about 5%. That one number went everywhere. It's on the flyer for your kid's camp, it's in every neck trainer ad, it's the whole pitch.

Then people pooled the research. A meta-analysis in JOSPT gathered 8 studies and 7,625 athletes and found a small, nonsignificant relationship, graded very low certainty, with heterogeneity over 90%, which kind of means the studies wildly disagreed with each other. And a new systematic review this January in Current Sports Medicine Reports went back through it

and landed on inconclusive.

So why is neck work still on my programs? Because it earns its spot on things I can actually see. Stingers. Cervical strain. Head and eye position going into contact. Holding a good tackling posture in the 4th quarter.

That's a real sell, and it's honest.

When you market neck work as a concussion shield and a kid gets concussed anyway, that family stops believing anything you say about prevention. You just spent trust you needed later.

Train the neck. Sell it on what it actually does.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Every August a camp sells you neck training as concussion insurance. Two reviews say it isn't.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take for August. Neck training probably doesn't prevent concussions, and I program it anyway.

Here's where the belief came from. A study years back reported that for every pound of neck strength, concussion odds dropped about 5%. That one number went everywhere. It's on the flyer for your kid's camp, it's in every neck trainer ad, it's the whole pitch.

Then people pooled the research. A meta-analysis in JOSPT gathered 8 studies and 7,625 athletes and found a small, nonsignificant relationship, graded very low certainty, with heterogeneity over 90%, which kind of means the studies wildly disagreed with each other. And a new systematic review this January in Current Sports Medicine Reports went back through it and landed on inconclusive.

So why is neck work still on my programs? Because it earns its spot on things I can actually see. Stingers. Cervical strain. Head and eye position going into contact. Holding

a good tackling posture in the 4th quarter.

That's a real sell, and it's honest.

When you market neck work as a concussion shield and a kid gets concussed anyway, that family stops believing anything you say about prevention. You just spent trust you needed later.

Train the neck. Sell it on what it actually does.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "Neck training prevents concussions"
- 0:08 Where that came from: one study, 5% per pound
- 0:20 JOSPT meta-analysis: 8 studies, 7,625 athletes
- 0:28 Small, NONSIGNIFICANT. Very low certainty.
- 0:36 Jan 2026 review: inconclusive
- 0:46 So why do I still program it?
- 0:52 Stingers. Cervical strain. Head position. Tackling posture.

- 1:05 Train the neck. Sell it on what it actually does.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Neck training probably doesn't prevent concussions. I still program it.

The belief traces back to one study reporting roughly a 5% drop in concussion odds per pound of neck strength. That number ended up on camp flyers and in every neck trainer ad.

Then the research got pooled. A JOSPT meta-analysis of 8 studies and 7,625 athletes found a small, nonsignificant relationship graded very low certainty, with heterogeneity over 90%, meaning the studies disagreed with each other badly. A systematic review published this January in Current Sports Medicine Reports reached the same place: inconclusive.

Neck work still earns its spot on my programs for the things I can actually see. Stingers. Cervical strain. Head and eye position going into contact. Tackling posture that holds up in the 4th quarter.

Here's the cost of overselling it. When you market neck work as a concussion shield and an athlete gets concussed anyway, that family stops trusting everything else you say about prevention. Honesty is the durable version.

Train the neck. Sell it on what it actually does.

It's time to cross your threshold. Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #concussion #neckstrength
#athletedevelopment
#strengthandconditioning #sportsmedicine
#youthathletes #injuryprevention
#sportsperformance #restonva

Personalize this

- You program neck work for your HS football athletes. What exactly is in it, and what have you actually watched improve, stingers, head position in contact, tackling posture late in games?
- Has a football parent ever asked you directly whether neck training protects

against concussion? How did you answer, and would you answer it differently after reading these two reviews?

- Threshold's positioning is honest prevention over marketed prevention. Where else in the youth sports world do you see a training tool sold on an outcome the evidence doesn't support yet?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41524441/> | "Evaluation of Neck Strength and Concussion Risk: A Systematic Review"
- physiology | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37428807/> | "There was very low-certainty evidence suggesting a small, nonsignificant relationship between greater neck strength and a lower risk of sustaining a SRC"

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41524441/>

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37428807/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Xie et al., *Nature Communications* 2026, creatine and megakaryocyte CKB-STAT5B metastasis signaling. Mouse models plus an 11-person healthy-adult platelet transfer arm, no human cancer outcome measured. Worth a calm "what the study actually did" Reel if parents start asking, framed entirely around keeping the athlete's protocol steady.
- ACSM 2026 Resistance Training Guidelines, first update in 17 years. Concrete numbers (80% 1RM for 2-3 sets for strength, ~10 sets/muscle/week for size, 30-70% 1RM moved fast for power) as a foil for "these are general-population minimums, here's what changes for an in-season athlete."
- RED-S and low energy availability in HS athletes: Triad risk factors carry a 30-50% bone stress injury risk. Strong uncovered fueling lane, needs a fresh primary source.

Sources scanned today

- **Newsletter digest (2026-07-22):** single source, Mike T. Nelson, "Creatine Causes Cancer?" Breaks down Xie et al., *Nature Communications* 2026, creatine and megakaryocyte CKB–STAT5B metastasis signaling in mice plus an 11-person healthy-adult platelet arm. Genuinely newsworthy and Nelson's read is measured. Held as a runner-up rather than drafted: the tone steer routes away from cancer/mortality framing as the day's pick, and the honest takeaway (mouse mechanism, no human cancer outcome) is thin for a 90-second Reel. Rest of the digest was creatine-manual promo.
- **PubMed — hamstrings/preseason:** Saito et al., *Sports Health* 2026;18(2):354-360, GPS cohort of 67 elite soccer players 2021-2023. Full odds ratios and conclusion verified verbatim off the PubMed record (PMID 41327818). Chosen for Draft A. Timed to HS football/lacrosse camp opening in the next 2 weeks. Clean vs registry.

- **PubMed — neck strength/concussion:**
Garrett et al., *JOSPT* 2023;53(10):585-593 meta-analysis (8 studies, 7,625 athletes) and Postula et al., *Current Sports Medicine Reports*, January 2026 systematic review. Two independent reviews landing in the same place against a claim that is everywhere in football marketing. Chosen for Draft B. Clean vs registry.
- **ACSM 2026 Resistance Training Guidelines** (first update in 17 years, March 2026): read in full. Concrete numbers exist (80% 1RM for 2-3 sets, ~10 sets/muscle/week, 30-70% 1RM for power), but the framing is general-population and the headline quotes are truisms. Held as a runner-up foil.
- **Unreachable / blocked:** Sagepub (Saito full text) 403, nature.com (Xie et al.) redirected to auth wall, jospt.org 403. All three routed to PubMed mirrors instead, which is also what the screenshot script renders best.

- **Also scanned, nothing fresher than registry coverage:** BJSM/JOSPT recent listings, sprint/plyometric adolescent RCTs, RED-S and low energy availability, youth in-season resistance training. Registry already covers plyos, resisted sprint, deceleration, warm-up, dynamic stretching, sleep, HRV, foam rolling, massage guns, adolescent nutrition and match-exposure hamstring load inside 30 days.
- Both chosen primary URLs confirmed absent from cited-sources.json within 90 days.